AWS Community Builders Application Worshop

Prepare ahead for a standout application in 2026!

By: Airah Y.

Agenda**

1. Intro!
2. Programme Overview
3. Application Walkthrough
4. Preparation Guide
5. Renewal Applications
6. Summary
7. Q & A

NOTE: Today's session includes interactive exercises, **engage engage engage****One **AWS BuilderCards in** up for grabs**!**

About Me

Airat Yusuff (Airah)

- Software Engineer, WCC Lead
- AWS Community Builder since 2022
- Renewed for **4th year*** in 2025
- Documented my L&D journey on blogs, social social media

Programme Overview

Did You Know?

~22%

was the ***acceptance rate*** into the programme in 2025!

- Why such a low acceptance rate?

SO, What is the program even about?

Programme Overview

About

- Highly selective and competitive initiative
- **Resources** and **networking opportunities**
- **Anyone** passionate about cloud computing/AWS services.

Categories

- Specialised tracks for different AWS focus areas
- **Developer Tools, Containers, Serverless, etc**

Key Benefits

- **Recognition!**
- AWS credits
- New joiner/Renewal swags 😎
- 1-year subscription to QA
- Exclusive networking opportunities **and more!**

MY Favorite Benefits

- AWS Credits
- Swags
- Everything else! 😊

▶ **Applications for 2026 will likely open in January**

Questions Breakdown

In this application, you will be asked for links to existing **public** technical content or other community contributions that you have created 1-12 months ago. **We will not consider applications with content published within four weeks of your application because we're looking for builders with established patterns of helping other builders with their content.**

If you do not have a minimum of two community contributions in the past 12 months your application will not be accepted. Social media and short-form forum posts are not considered community contributions for the purpose of this application. If you do not meet these requirements, we encourage you to work on your contributions and apply to our program during next year.

Do you meet the requirements as explained above?

◉ I meet the requirements to apply for this program

○ I do not meet the requirements to apply for this program

1

Housekeeping

- Contact/demographic info.
- Currently part of any AWS Community Programs?
- Currently an AWS employee?

2

Factual

- Frequency of activities related to AWS
- Topic area of interest
- **Content Links!!!**
  - **minimum of TWO,**

3

Key

- How does your **background** bring a **unique perspective** to the program?
- Provide an example of something you've built using AWS services

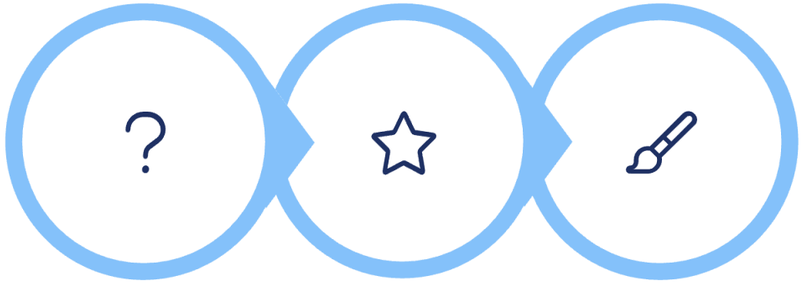
Others: AI usage disclaimer, community referral, etc

Interactive Exercise - Your Application

Question 1: We strive to create and maintain a diverse community within the AWS Community Builders Program.

How does your background bring a unique perspective to the program?

Question 2: Would you like to provide an example of something you've built using AWS services? What did you build, how, why, and what did you learn?



Answers from the chat will be picked and reviewed!

Successful Answers

Question 1: We strive to create and maintain a diverse community within the AWS Community Builders Program.

How does your background bring a unique perspective to the program?

Zeynab Yusuf · 1st
DevOps Engineer | DevSecOps | AWS Community Builder

As a Black, visibly Muslim woman, I see the AWS Community Builder programme as an **amazing chance to connect with people and grow my community outreach**. It's a great way to **meet others** who are just as **passionate about making tech more inclusive and accessible** and I'm excited about the ideas and collaborations that could come from it.

I'm all about **pushing for more diversity in tech,** especially for Black women and **I want to use this platform to make a real difference**. By sharing what I learn about AWS through my blogs and documenting my journey, **I hope to inspire other women of colour to dive into tech careers.** It's all about building a space where everyone feels they belong and can thrive.

Successful Answers

Question 2: Would you like to provide an example of something you've built using AWS services? What did you build, how did you build it, why did you build it, why did you build it, and what did you learn along the way?

Samia Khan · 1st
AWS DevOps Engineer @ Version 1 | AWS Community Builder

Something I've built recently for a client was **a backup and recovery system using AWS backup and lambda.**
The **client did not have an effective DR process in place for their VMs** which meant that if a VM stopped they did not have updated snapshots to recover it from.
I **created CloudFormation templates** to create a backup vault in their main account and the backup account.
I **automated the backup schedule** by having a backup policy in place to take automatic backups daily of EC2 and RDS instances and then copy the backups to the backup account.
I **discovered that RDS backups cant be copied across accounts and regions at the same time**, you can either do a cross account copy or a cross region copy in one go. As the main account was in eu-west-2 and the backup account used eu-west-1, I **implemented a python lambda function and eventbridge rules to automate the process**. The backup vault policy would copy the snapshot from the main account to the backup account vault in eu-west-2. An eventbridge rule would monitor this process for completion then trigger a lambda function in the backup account to copy the snapshot from the backup vault in eu-west-2 to eu-west-1 allowing for an automated process.
I **learned a lot about RDS and its uses and limitations** and also **how lambda functions can be used to automate even simple processes like copying snapshots across regions.**

Zeynab Yusuf · 1st
DevOps Engineer | DevSecOps | AWS Community Builder

A project I'm really proud of is the **deployment of the Threat Composer app made by AWS**. This was **my first experience with ECS**, and it **turned out to be a wonderful learning opportunity**. I also **used AWS Certificate Manager (ACM) for managing SSL certificates** for the app.

Watching the project come to life was an amazing experience. Beyond the technical skills I gained, **this project became a great conversation starter during interviews**. Sharing my screen and walking through the project **allowed me to effectively showcase my thought process and skills**, which I believe helped me secure a role. I'm **truly thankful to AWS for providing the resources and motivation to make this happen**.

Interactive Exercise - Your Answers

Question 1: We strive to create and maintain a diverse community within the AWS Community Builders Program.

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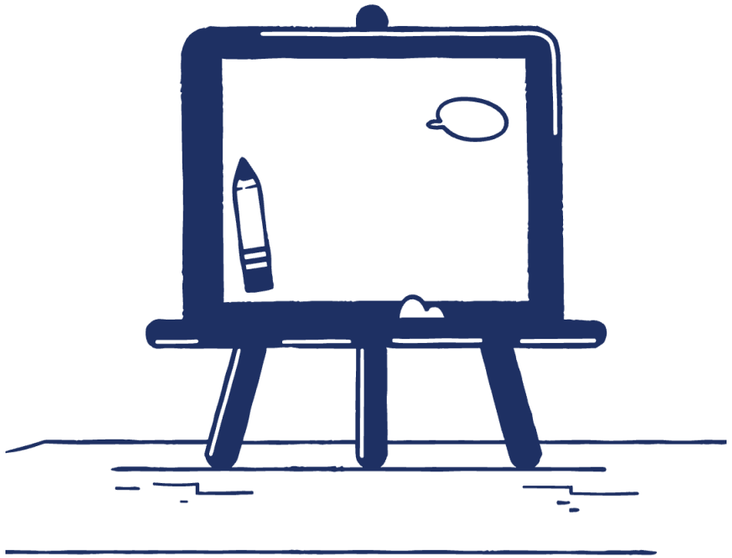
Question 2: Would you like to provide an example of something you've built using AWS services?

What did you build, how, why, and what did you learn?



How to Prepare?

LEARN

CREATE

DOCUMENT

- written contents, videos, podcasts

How to Prepare?

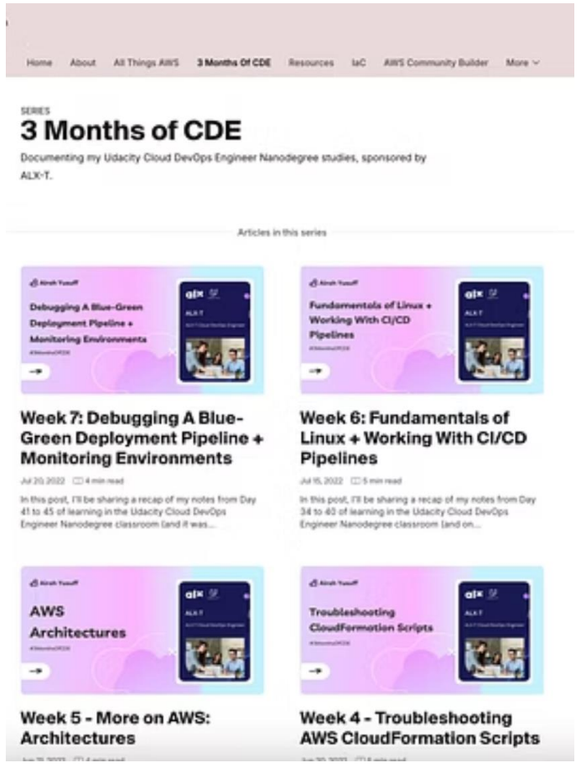
- **Platforms**

Blog Posts

YouTube Videos

Podcasts

LinkedIn Articles



How to Prepare?

- **Alternatives**

1. Deliver a technical session on AWS at events
2. Participate in Project challenges
3. Study for AWS certifications
4. Consume content from other CBs

Pro tip: Focus on learning, knowledge sharing, & consistency.

Renewal Applications

- Annually: March - April
- Decision by May

Question 1: Why would you like to return as a Community Builder for another year?

Question 2: What are some of the highlights of the past year for you related to AWS or your time in our community program?

Provide **TWO (and only TWO)** content links, with a brief description on the content

Optional: Suggestions to improve the program

First Renewal (2023)

2023 RENEWAL

>> Why would you like to return as a Community Builder for another year?
One of my highlights for 2022 was joining the program because it opened up several learning opportunities for me. As a frontend engineer that's transitioning to the operations/devOps side of things, being a part of the program allowed me gain insights and experience working with cloud technologies and tools (with a focus on AWS of course). I have been able to share my growing knowledge with other enthusiasts by writing articles and creating content on social platforms. I would love to continue being a Community Builder so I can continue sharing my journey and helping others start theirs.

>> What are some of the highlights of the past year for you related to AWS or your time in our community program?
1) I learnt and wrote articles on the program, and different AWS services focusing on IaC, containerisation and container orchestration.
2) Created social content on Instagram and LinkedIn to create more awareness about the program, benefits of joining, and sharing updates that might be useful (e.g the newly launched Cloud Clubs program)
3) Learnt Terraform with Cloud Academy
4) Passed my AWS Cloud Practitioner certification exam (and looking forward to attempting the SAA)

>> Content Links descriptions:
1) A tutorial on how to deploy multiple backend APIs into AWS EKS clusters. I incorporated the power of chatGPT to show how the AI tool can be used to improve one's learning as someone building experience in these cloud technologies.
2) A tutorial on how to convert AWS CloudFormation templates to Terraform scripts. Like me, a lot of builders new to working with cloud technologies continuously pick up new tools to learn and since Terraform is an IaC tool that companies typically use, I shared my experience trying to go from working with CloudFormation to Terraform since they are both used for IaC.

Latest Renewal (2025)

2025 RENEWAL

>> Why would you like to return as a Community Builder for another year?
Being a part of the program continues to allow me to grow my technical skills and expand my network with credibility. In 2024, I focused on reaffirming the target audience for my contents and the value I wanted to provide to them. As a software engineer looking to transition to a fully-focused cloud role, my target was fellow cloud enthusiasts with similar goals (with/without development experience) that wanted to learn more about AWS services through hands-on projects. As such, I continued to write blogposts that present what I've learnt about various AWS services to other community builders and people new to cloud services in a project-focused, simplified and relatable but equally technical approach.
I have also been building the Cloud/DevOps track within Women Coding Community where some of the workshops I organise utilise AWS (serverless) services. I would love to return as a Community Builder so I can continue building this community of women interested in cloud careers, and sharing my journey with AWS while advocating for others to do so as well.

>> What are some of the highlights of the past year for you related to AWS or your time in our community program?
1) The main highlight for me is how I am now leading the Cloud/DevOps track within Women Coding Community. Within this track, I share AWS-related resources and also launched an ongoing Cloud Career Journeys series to explore various cloud-focused roles; these sessions provide the opportunity to talk about AWS services during Q&A discussions.
2) My articles focused more on hands-on projects (development/deployment, IaC, containerisation) and trying more unfamiliar AWS services like EventBridge.
3) I continued to spotlight the Community Builder program and its benefits to members within Women Coding Community in our online sessions and community Slack channel. E.g the recent AWS credits giveaway that I was able to organise for them, thanks to my access to the program.

>> Content Links descriptions:
1) A hands-on walkthrough focusing on understanding Lambda functions and its integration and usage with various AWS services using a project use-case. Ideal for technical builders looking to build their AWS cloud projects portfolio.
2) The content focuses on how developers with limited knowledge of AWS/cloud services can migrate their local MySQL databases to Amazon RDS instances for projects they want to deploy. It also highlights the importance of technical documentation when working on projects, not only for other technical builders but also one's future self.

Summary

Start Your Preparation Today!

- Learn more about services within AWS
- Focus on your interest areas
- **Visibility matters** - document, document, document!
- Connect with current CBs on LinkedIn
- Be Genuine

Applications open **January 2026** — build your portfolio consistently consistently until then!

Thank You!

Questions?

- LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/khairah-yusuff
- Blog: khairahscorner.hashnode.dev